limit to how far they'd go in opposing what the folks back home wanted.

During the first year or two in Sacramento, I kept my distance from legislators. Nancy and I had never done much partying in Hollywood—our idea of an exciting evening was to spend it at home with the children—and when we got to Sacramento, we hadn't plunged into the social world there either, causing some of the legislators to regard us as snobs.

There were still some hard feelings toward me left over from the campaign, when I'd gone out of my way to say I thought the professional politicians in Sacramento and I were natural enemies: My loyalty was to the people, not the political establishment, and I had said so fairly pointedly. Although that sentiment never changed, I realized after a while that to accomplish what I wanted to do swimming upstream against a current of opposition legislators, I'd have to do some negotiating with them. And that meant I'd make a truce of sorts with the opposition, meet with them socially, invite them over for a drink, get to know them. I began doing that. And the more time I spent in government, the more I realized that legislators and congressmen were often less responsible for the growth of government and taxes than the "permanent government"—the people in the bureaucracies who were forever trying to enlarge their power and budgets and prolong programs after their need had expired. As I'd learned back in Dixon, the first rule of the bureaucracy is, protect the bureaucracy.

I began to socialize with the legislators, and in more on-the-job training, I also discovered the value of picking up a telephone and calling a legislator to tell him or her why I thought he or she should vote for something I wanted.

Although I may have been a former actor, I knew something about negotiating. As president of the Screen Actors Guild, I'd matched wits with some of the shrewdest